

BERNSTEIN

SOCIETE GENERALE GROUP

Global Memory

SK Hynix Inc

Rating

Outperform

Price Target

 000660.KS

1,150,000 KRW



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SK hynix 1Q26: Favorable price to persist

1Q26 results were mostly in line with the latest 28D consensus, but earnings beat on revaluation gains on the KIOXIA stake. 2Q26 was guided to see decent bit growth for DRAM & NAND bit shipment to rebound from a dip in 1Q26.

SK hynix sees strong pricing environment to persist. SK hynix views shortage structural, & customers prioritizing supply over price. Thus strong pricing environment likely will last longer vs before. And the slowing spot price is seen as temporary & not a sign of cycle peak.

HBM demand said to far exceed supply in the next three years. HBM4 will enter production in line with customer schedule but no specific timing was given. HBM4E is sampling in 2H26 with production targeted for 2027. Notably, SK hynix sees HBM demand far exceeding its supply in the next three years, & its capacity allocation will be balanced between HBM & conventional DRAM.

2026 capex was guided to rise significantly YoY, but no specifics. Spending will prioritize on infrastructure & strategic tools. Yongin Fab 1 (Y1) phase 1 cleanroom will be ready in Feb 2027, slated for DRAM, with 6 phases planned in total.

Pursue both financial soundness and expanding shareholder return. SK hynix now sees reinvestment as the best use of cash & targets +KRW100T net cash for future capex. SK hynix believes it can be achieved along with expanding shareholder returns, and both dividend & buyback plans are being reviewed for implementation the year. Additionally, ADR offering is being reviewed by the SEC, with the target of listing the year.

Significant NAND capacity addition is being achieved through tech upgrades, with 50% of domestic capacity moving to 321L by EOY26.

Overall, we also see robust price outlook in the next few quarters & maintain Outperform.

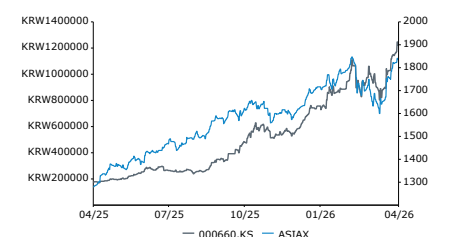
Reported EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E
000660.KS (KRW)	60,341	286,732	385,594

Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR
Revenues (M)	97,147*	307,701*	406,986*	--
EBIT (M)	47,113*	249,571*	335,299*	--
BV/Share (M)	163,846.86	429,464.96	776,526.27	--
CapEx (M)	27,520	42,098	47,451	--
Dividend Payout Ratio (%)	5.0	7.3	10.0	--
ROE (%)	44.1	94.7	63.2	--

*Values shown in billions; Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Close Date	22 Apr 2026			
000660.KS Close Price (KRW)	1,220,000			
Price Target (KRW)	1,150,000			
Upside/(Downside)	(6)%			
52-Week Range	1,247,000/176,700			
ASIAx	1,835.50			
FYE	Dec			
Div Yield	0.2%			
Market Cap (KRW) (B)	869,496.89			
EV (KRW) (B)	859,463.05			
Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	87.1	30.8	155.8	574.0
ASIAx (%)	12.2	12.3	13.5	42.5
Relative (%)	74.9	18.4	142.3	531.6
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.				

Price Performance, 1YR



See the Disclosure Appendix of this report for required disclosures, analyst certifications and other important information. Alternatively, visit our [Global Research Disclosure Website](#).

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EXHIBIT 1: SK hynix 1Q26 results were in line with latest 28 day consensus, except earnings beat on revaluation gains related to KIOXIA investment.

(KRW in Bn)	4Q25 Actual	1Q26 Actual	QoQ	Bernstein	Consensus	Difference vs.	
						Bernstein	Consensus
Revenue	32,827	52,576	60.2%	48,145	53,366	9.2%	-1.5%
Gross Profit	22,576	41,679	84.6%	38,175	42,573	9.2%	-2.1%
Margin	68.8%	79.3%	10.5%	79.3%	79.8%	0.0%	-0.5%
Operating Profit	19,170	37,610	96.2%	34,549	38,218	8.9%	-1.6%
Margin	58.4%	71.5%	13.1%	71.8%	71.6%	-0.2%	-0.1%
Net Income	15,246	40,346	164.6%	28,199	31,309	43.1%	28.9%
Margin	46.4%	76.7%	30.3%	58.6%	58.7%	18.2%	18.1%
Basic EPS (KRW)	21,852	57,175	161.6%	40,515	44,352	41.1%	28.9%

28 day consensus

Source: Company reports, Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 2: 1Q26 ASP increase was above our expectation esp for DRAM.

DRAM			NAND		
1Q26			1Q26		
2Q26			2Q26		
ASP QoQ			ASP QoQ		
1Q Actual	+Mid 60s%		1Q Actual	+Mid 70s%	
Bernstein Forecast	40.5%	45.9%	Bernstein Forecast	70.0%	65.0%
Bit Shipment QoQ			Bit Shipment QoQ		
1Q Actual/2Q Guide	Flat	+HSD%	1Q Actual/2Q Guide	- approx 10%	+MT%
Bernstein Forecast	0.0%	3.0%	Bernstein Forecast	-2.0%	0.0%
1Q Guidance	Flat		1Q Guidance	Slightly down	

Source: Company reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis

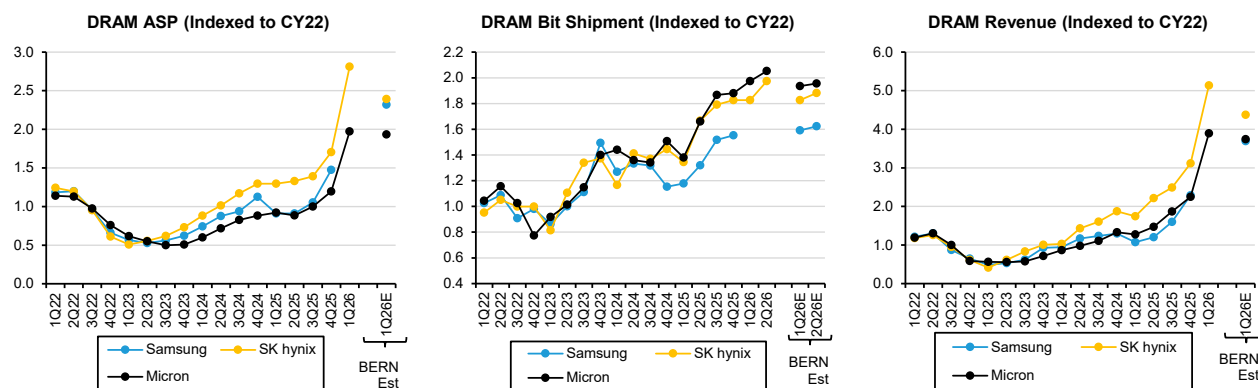
EXHIBIT 3: 1Q26 ASP increase was very similar to Micron.

DRAM			NAND		
1Q26			1Q26		
2Q26			2Q26		
ASP QoQ			ASP QoQ		
1Q Actual			1Q Actual		
SK hynix	+Mid 60s%		SK hynix	+Mid 70s%	
Micron*	+mid 60s%		Micron*	+high 70s%	
Bit Shipment QoQ			Bit Shipment QoQ		
1Q Actual/2Q Guide			1Q Actual/2Q Guide		
SK hynix	Flat	+HSD%	SK hynix	- approx 10%	+MT%
Micron*	+MSD%	modest growth	Micron*	+LSD%	modest growth

*Calendar quarter; Micron's quarter ends a month earlier

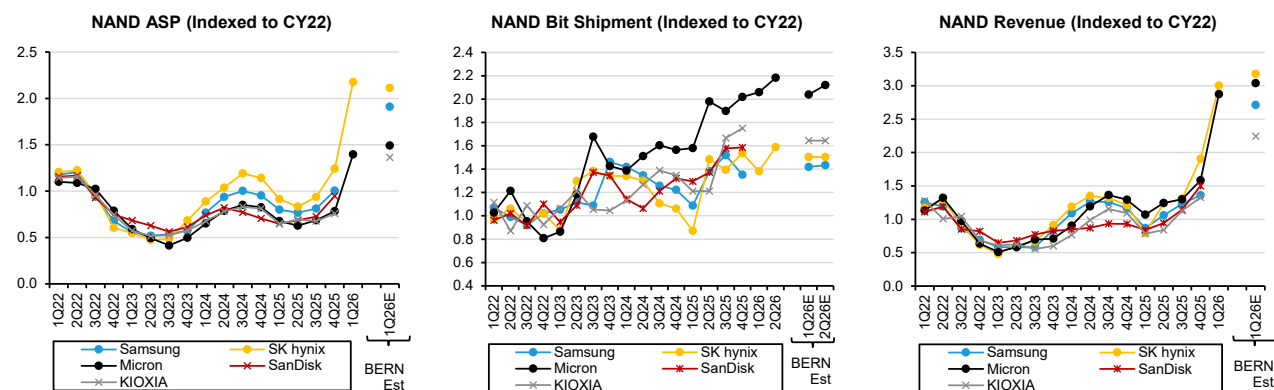
Source: Company report, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 4: SK hynix 1Q26 DRAM revenue beat our expectation due to resilient HBM revenue and also better than expected DRAM price increase.



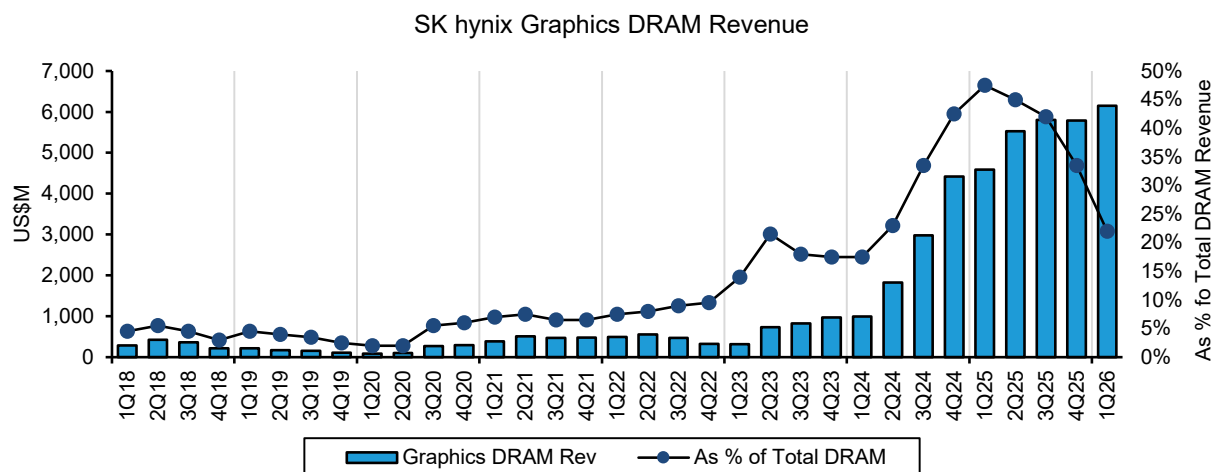
Calendar quarters; 2Q26 is based on company guidance; Micron's quarter ends 1 month earlier
Source: Company reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 5: SK hynix's 1Q26 NAND revenue was a bit behind expectation due to decline in bit shipment, though 2Q26 is guided to see shipment bounce back.



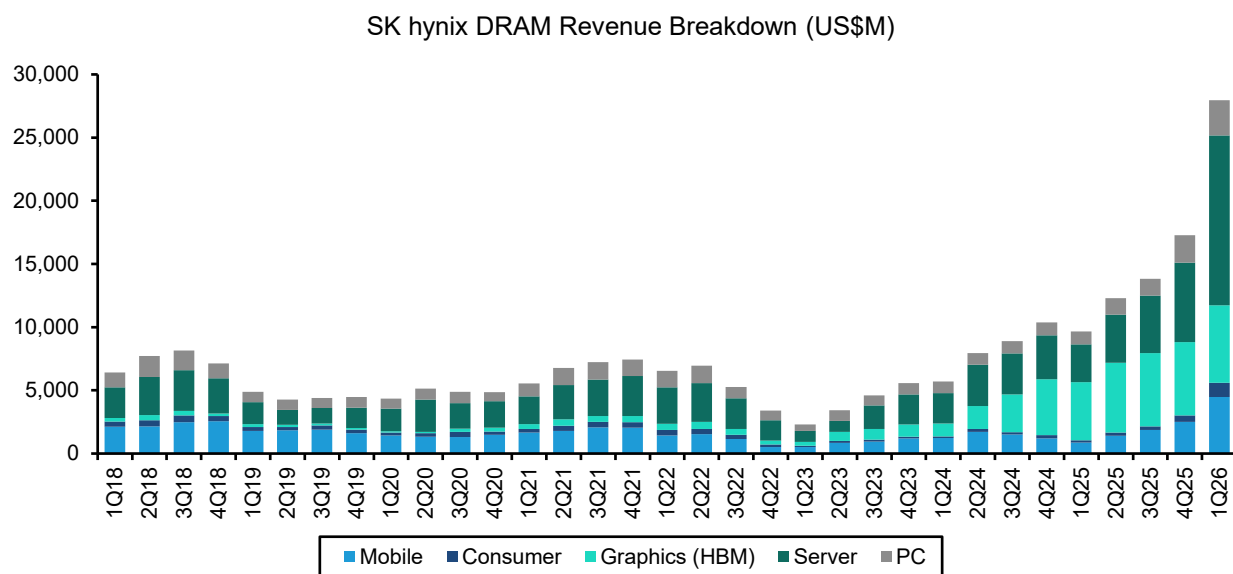
Calendar quarters; 2Q26 is based on company guidance; Micron's quarter ends 1 month earlier
Source: Company reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 6: Graphics DRAM revenue, principally supported by HBM, was up moderately QoQ in 1Q26, above our expectation, despite likely lower HBM3E pricing under new contract.

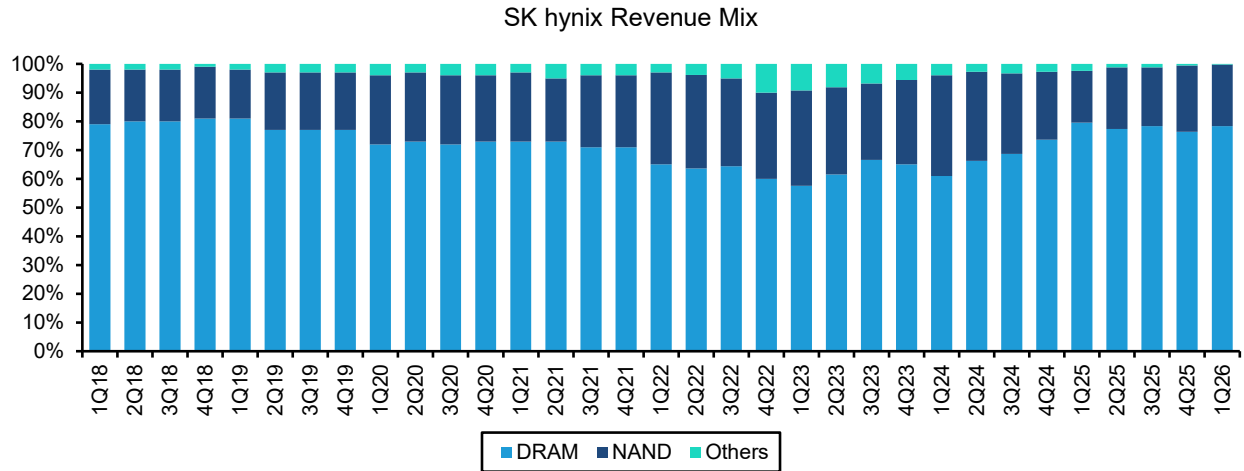


Source: Company reports and Bernstein analysis

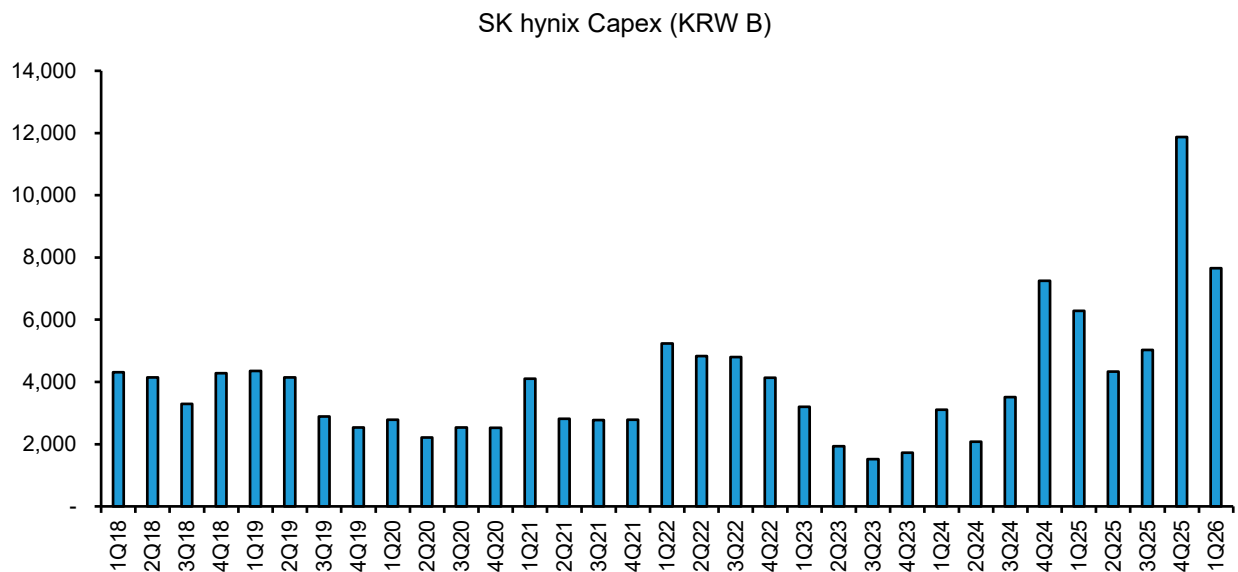
EXHIBIT 7: DRAM revenue shot up in 1Q26 due to the mid-60s% increase in ASP.



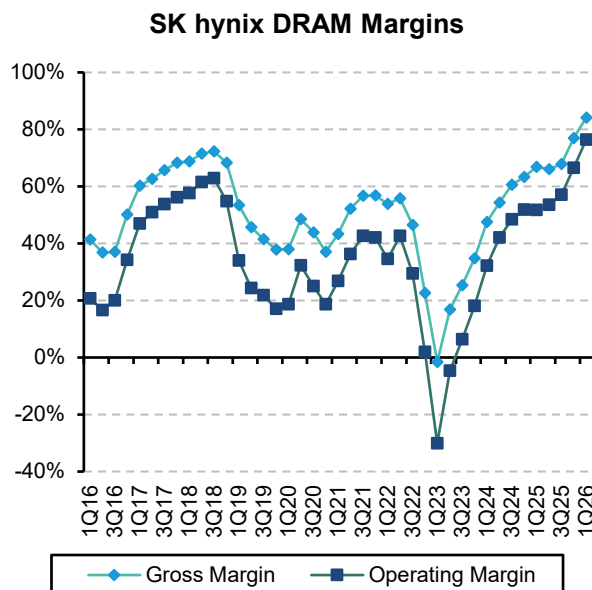
Source: Company reports and Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 8: **DRAM mix increased over NAND due to better bit shipment growth.**

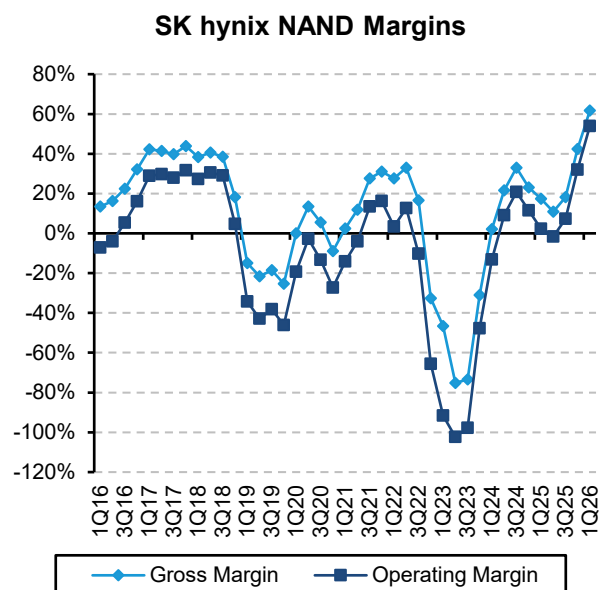
Source: Company reports and Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 9: **SK hynix capex dipped QoQ in 1Q26 mainly due to seasonality but remained at higher level than most of 2025.**

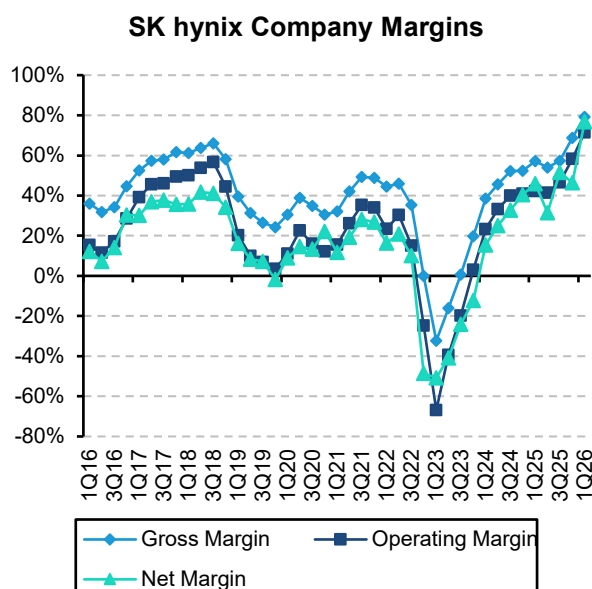
Source: Company reports and Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 10: **DRAM gross margin rose to mid 80s%.**

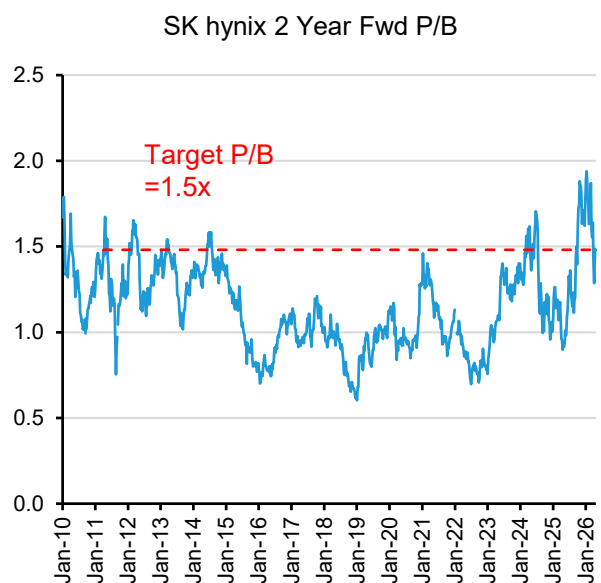
Excludes inventory write-down/reversal
Source: Company reports and Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 11: **NAND gross margin likely surpassed 60% as well.**

Excludes inventory write-down/reversal
Source: Company report, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 12: **Overall corporate gross margin reached about 80%, notably above the last peak in 2017-18.**

Source: Company report, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 13: **SK hynix is trading at reasonable valuation now.**

Source: Bloomberg and Bernstein analysis

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

We rate SK hynix Outperform with PT=KRW 1,150,000

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	22 Apr 2026			TTM Rel. Perf.	Reported EPS				Reported P/E (x)		
		Cur	Closing Price	Price Target		Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
000660.KS (SK hynix)	O	KRW	1,220,000	1,150,000	531.6%	KRW	60,341	286,732	385,594	20.2	4.3	3.2
ASIAAX			1,835.50									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY**SK Hynix Inc**

We value SK hynix with 1.5x of 2-year forward BVPS and arrive at price target of KRW1,150,000.

RISKS**SK Hynix Inc**

The biggest downside risk to our target price is an earlier end of favorable pricing environment, which can be a result of weaker demand or higher supply. Investor sentiment and hence the valuation rewarded by investors is also a risk. China's progress in memory, especially in NAND, is a downside risk too.

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The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIA) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

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Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

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Those denoted as 'Feature' (e.g., Feature Outperform FOP, Feature Under Outperform FUP) are our core ideas.

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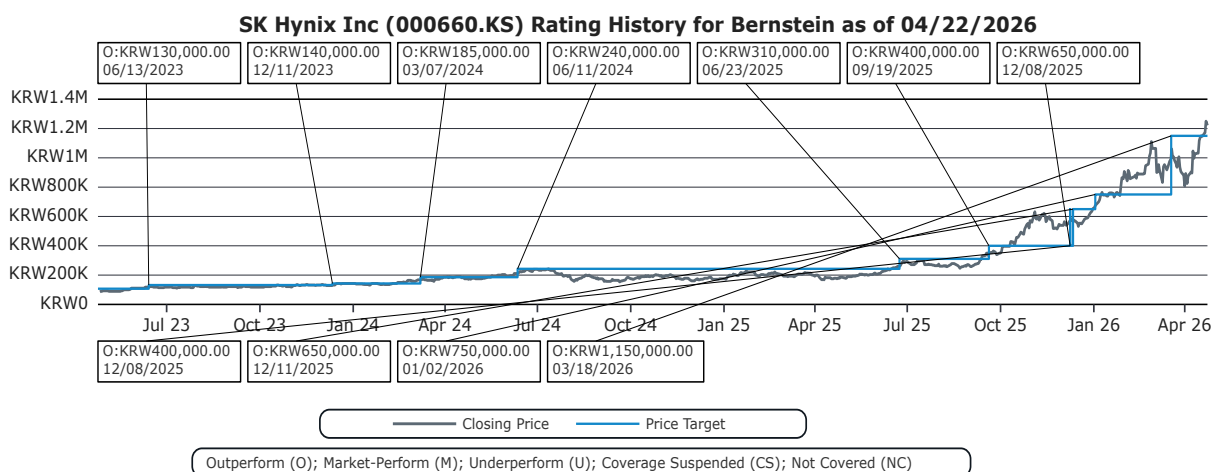
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Equity Rating	Market Abuse Regulation (MAR) and FINRA Rating Category	Global Rating Distribution	Investment Banking Relationships*
Outperform	BUY	51.1%	16.5%
Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	36.3%	17.8%
Underperform	SELL	12.6%	14.9%

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.

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